

INTERNSHIP COMPLETION REPORT

Cybersecurity Job Simulation

Mastercard virtual work experience, delivered through the Forage platform — August 2026

SUBMITTED BY

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Roll No. 2410031106 · Batch 2024–
2028 Semester: 5

SUBMITTED TO

**School of Computer Science &
Engineering**

IILM University, Greater Noida, U.P.

In partial fulfilment of the requirement for the degree of **B.Tech CSE** · 2026–27



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Why this domain

Cybersecurity is a critical domain focused on protecting **networks, devices and data** from unauthorized access or malicious attacks.

This report details my experience completing a Cybersecurity Job Simulation developed by **Mastercard via Forage** in August 2026. The simulation provided practical exposure to tasks performed by security analysts, specifically focusing on human-centric vulnerabilities such as phishing.

SIMULATION AT A GLANCE

HOST ORGANIZATION

Mastercard

PLATFORM

Forage

PERIOD

August 2026

PRACTICAL TASKS

Two modules

A partnership of two

THE EMPLOYER

Mastercard

A global pioneer in payment innovation and technology, processing **billions of secure transactions** globally — making cybersecurity a paramount operational pillar.

Scale of transaction volume makes human-layer defence a business-critical concern, not an IT afterthought.

THE PLATFORM

Forage

An educational technology platform that partners with top global corporations to create **virtual work experience programs** simulating real-world corporate tasks.

Empowering emerging professionals to build relevant, industry-specific skills before entering the workforce.

Despite advanced perimeter defenses, organizations remain highly vulnerable to **social engineering**.

THE CORE PROBLEM ADDRESSED

The need to proactively assess and mitigate employee vulnerability to phishing attacks — by designing realistic threat simulations and accurately interpreting the resulting compromise data.

1

Firewalls do not filter human judgement

Technical controls stop at the inbox.

2

Risk must be measured to be managed

Simulation converts exposure into data.

3

Interpretation drives the remedy

Metrics point to the awareness gap.

Four objectives of the internship

01

Understand the mechanics of social engineering and phishing attacks

Foundation — how attackers exploit trust.

02

Design a realistic phishing email simulation for an enterprise environment

Module one deliverable.

03

Analyze and interpret the results of a phishing simulation campaign

Module two deliverable.

04

Identify security awareness gaps based on simulation metrics

The outcome that closes the loop.

What was in scope

The scope of this virtual simulation was limited to **two major practical tasks**.

TASK 01

Design a phishing email simulation

Crafting a simulated threat payload.

TASK 02

Interpret phishing simulation results

Click, reporting and compromise rates.

OUT OF SCOPE

No live penetration testing and no handling of real malicious malware.
Analysis used provided mock data sets of employee interactions.

4.6 TECHNOLOGIES & TOOLS

Security awareness & simulated phishing platforms

Conceptual workflow.

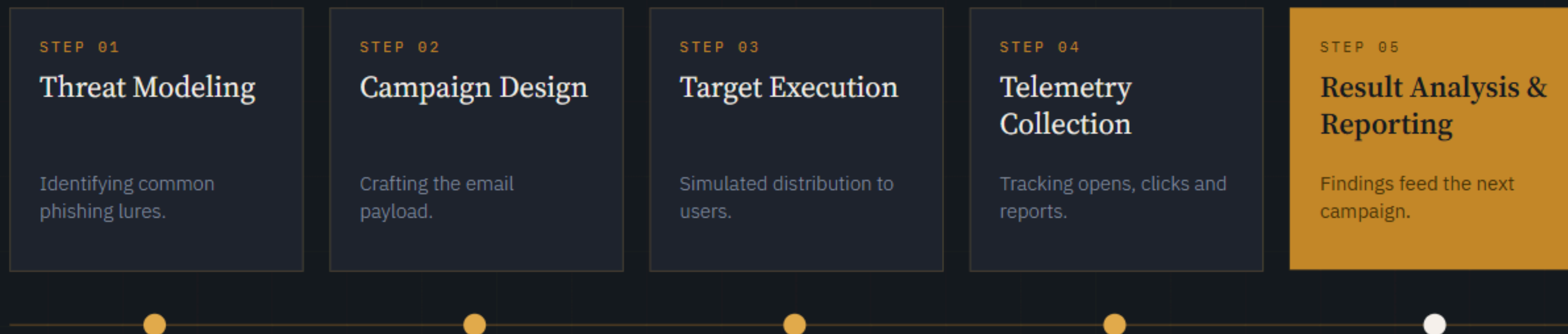
Data analysis software

Microsoft Excel / Google Sheets for interpreting simulation metrics.

Email & communication systems

Delivery medium of the simulated campaign.

Security awareness campaign workflow



The operational workflow followed a standard Security Awareness Campaign architecture — a closed loop in which analysis of one campaign informs the threat model of the next.

An adversarial simulation approach

MODULE ONE – QUALITATIVE

Designing the lure

Psychological triggers commonly used by threat actors were deliberately applied when composing the phishing email.

Urgency

Act now, or lose access

Authority

Sent from a superior

Curiosity

An unexplained document

MODULE TWO – QUANTITATIVE

Reading the response

Campaign metrics were reviewed analytically, separating resilient behaviour from vulnerable behaviour.

RESILIENT

Reporting the email

VULNERABLE

Clicking the link or submitting credentials

Deliverables of the simulation

A

A fully designed, realistic phishing email template

Ready for campaign deployment within an enterprise security awareness programme.

B

A comprehensive analytical report of the results

Highlighting key vulnerability areas within the simulated organization.

Together, these turn an invisible human risk into a **measurable, addressable** security metric.

4.10 / PROOF OF COMPLETION

Certificate

AWARDED TO

Devanshi Saini

PROGRAMME

Cybersecurity Job Simulation

DATE OF ISSUE

August 30th, 2026

SIGNED BY

Tom Brunskill — Co-Founder of Forage

Enrolment Code **6a9403cc6282564772be3454**

User Code **6a9315bd2eef4b8fc013fe5d**



Issued by Forage — Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation, August 2026

References

- 01 Forage. (2026). *Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation*. Retrieved from Forage Virtual Work Experience Platform.
- 02 Brunskill, T. (2026). *Certificate of Completion: Devanshi Saini*. Issued August 30, 2026.

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Thank you